James Clarke

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EDUCATION

San Diego State University *San Diego, CA*
Bachelor of Science, BS *Expected May 2029*
Major: *Computer Science* Minor: *Mathematics*
Relevant Coursework: *CS470 UNIX System Administration*

EXPERIENCE

SDSU Cyber Defense Team *San Diego, CA*
Deputy System Administrator *April 2026 - Present*
• Manage multi-OS virtualized infrastructure with WireGuard VPN, Windows Server, DNS/PKI, and Unix/Linux
• Deployed and monitored VMs and services using Proxmox, Terraform, Ansible, Packer, Forgejo, Docker, and LXC
• Participated in the WRCCDC Invitational as a Blue Team IT Team Member, defending Linux systems against simulated red-team attacks while analyzing logs, conducting Nmap scans, and supporting system hardening

SDSU Infrastructure Lab *San Diego, CA*
System Administrator *Jan. 2026 - May 2026*
• Built a multi-OS lab with DNS, LDAP, PKI, SMTP/IMAP, NFS, nginx/Docker, and centralized logging
• Deployed a multi-node Kubernetes cluster with fault-tolerant web services and automated failover

Regional Collegiate Penetration Testing Competition *Pomona, CA*
Penetration Testing Team Member *Oct. 2026*
• Conducted authorized penetration testing, performing network recon, and service enumeration to find attack paths
• Documented vulnerabilities, technical evidence, and risk-based remediation recommendations in a team report

San Diego Yacht Club *San Diego, CA*
Security Consultant *Sept. 2026 - Present*
• Conducted a cybersecurity risk assessment of the SDYC staff technology practices, systems, workflows, training, and security controls to evaluate confidentiality, integrity, availability, and overall security posture
• Reviewed access controls, least-privilege practices, and security frameworks to identify risks

Homelab
Personal Project
• Built a Proxmox lab with pfSense, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Ansible, Wireguard, and Tailscale, with dedicated resource pools for infrastructure, security tooling, monitoring, and operating system testing
• Ran Suricata and Splunk to monitor network traffic and detect suspicious activity on my network.

SKILLS

Networking & Security: TCP/IP, DNS, NFS/SMB, SSH, PKI, WireGuard, Tailscale, pfSense
Security Tools: Nmap, Wireshark, Splunk, Suricata
Infrastructure & DevOps: Proxmox, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Ansible, Azure, Nextcloud, nginx, Git
Operating Systems: Linux/UNIX, Windows Server, OpenBSD, FreeBSD, AlmaLinux, Ubuntu, Debian
Scripting: Python, C++, Bash

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ *Expected Dec. 2026*
Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate
National Cyber League Fall 2025 Team Game & Individual Game (x2)

ORGANIZATIONS

AITP (Association for IT Professionals) Member | SDSU AI Club Member